

INVENTING WORDS

v1.4.0

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. What is Gombro?
2. Getting Started
3. The Editor
4. The CmdBar
5. The Explorer
6. Search and Collections
7. Paragraph Versions
8. Project Notes
9. Baraja and Cut-up
10. Graph View
11. Hashtags
12. Import and Export
13. Borgian Algebra
14. The Diary

↑ top

- 15. Schrödinger Mode
- 16. Writing Plan
- 17. Session Notes and Badges
- 18. Hashtag Filtering
- 19. Text Scale
- 20. Obsidian Notebook
- 21. Backup and Recovery
- 22. Paths (Narrative Labyrinths)
- 23. Recommended Workflow
- 24. Keyboard Shortcuts
- 25. About the Author
- 26. Alphabetical Index

Chapter 1 — What is Gombro?

Gombro is a writing machine centered on one thing: the human invention of the word.

Not the polished word. Not the optimized word. The **word in motion** — following the drift of thought, the accident of order, the surprise of what comes next when nothing is forced.

There is no AI here. No autocomplete, no suggestions, no invisible hand steering your sentences toward the probable. Gombro is a tool entirely at the service of the writer's own flow.

Every writing session in Gombro is a **jazz improvisation** — a session in the musical sense. You open the instrument, you play, you stop. What you left behind is a record of the session: raw, alive, retrievable.

The writers who would have used Gombro

↑ top

Gombro is the word processor that Kafka would have used to fragment his diaries without resolving them. That Jacques Vaché would have used to cut up letters he never sent. That Gombrowicz would have used to shuffle chapters until the form itself became the argument. That Joyce would have used to draft *Nighttown* in disconnected bursts and recombine them at 3am. That Néstor Sánchez would have used to write *Siberia Blues* one splinter at a time. That Philip K. Dick would have used to write *The Man in the High Castle* or *VALIS* — novels where reality itself refuses to hold still.

What Gombro is not

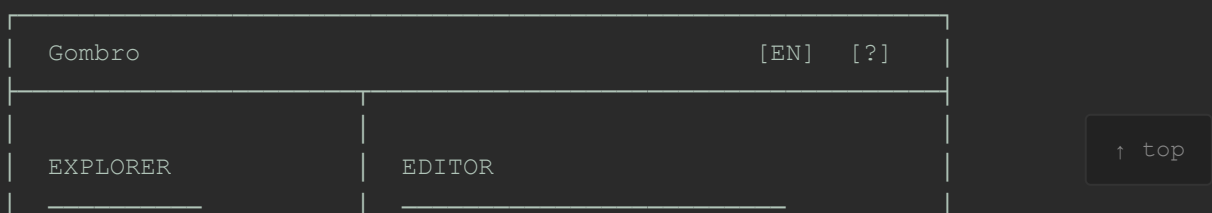
- It is not a word processor for final formatting
- It is not a project manager with folders, statuses, or deadlines
- It does not connect to the cloud or any external service
- **It contains no AI of any kind**

The two core concepts

CONCEPT	WHAT IT IS
Project	A container for a body of work — a novel, a story cycle, a notebook
Session	A single improvisation inside a project — a scene, a fragment, a drift

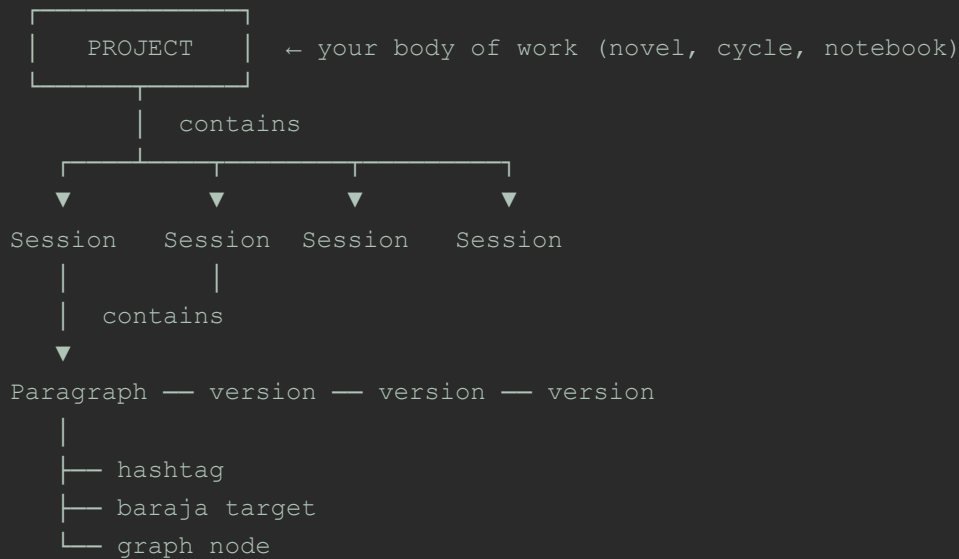
Chapter 2 — Getting Started

The interface at a glance



Sessions	
(empty)	Select a session to write.
[+] [↑]	

How it all connects:



- **Top bar** — language toggle `[EN]` and help button `[?]`
- **Explorer** — left panel, lists your sessions
- **Editor** — center/right panel, where you write
- **CmdBar** — bottom panel, the command terminal. Open with `:` or `/`. Press `Ctrl+T` for the floating palette.

Step 1 — Create your first project

Press `:` to open the CmdBar, then type:

```
create project Don Quixote
```

Press `Enter`. The project is created and becomes active.

[↑ top](#)

Step 2 — Create your first session

Press `Ctrl+N`, or open the CmdBar and type:

```
new Chapter One
```

Step 3 — Start writing

Click on the Editor area and start typing. That's it.

Key things to know

WHAT	HOW
Open the CmdBar	<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>
Create a session	<code>Ctrl+N</code> or <code>new <name></code> in CmdBar
Open Help	<code>[?]</code> button, <code>F1</code> , or <code>help</code> in CmdBar
Switch language	<code>[EN]</code> chip in top bar or <code>lang es</code> in CmdBar
Close any modal	<code>Esc</code>

Chapter 3 — The Editor

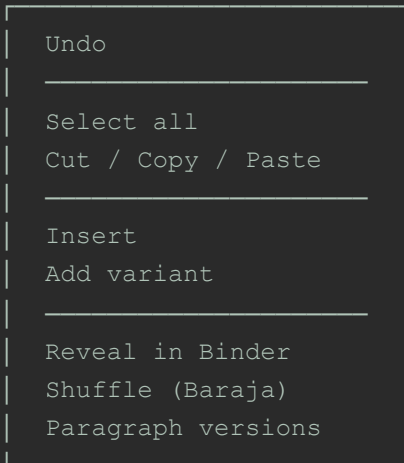
The Editor is where everything happens. It is intentionally bare — no toolbars, no formatting buttons, no rulers. Just the text and you.

Each block of text separated by a blank line is a **paragraph** — the fundamental unit in Gombro. Paragraphs are stored, versioned, shuffled, and tagged individually.

Context menu

Right-click anywhere in the editor to open the context menu:

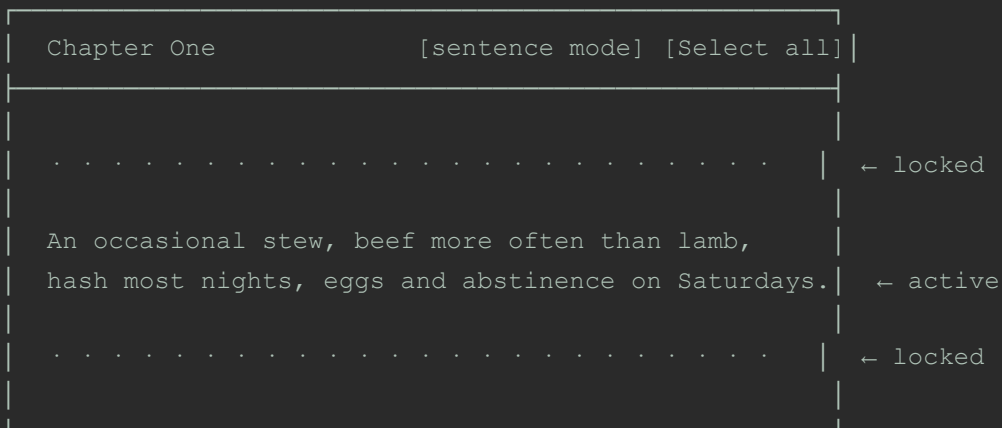
[↑ top](#)



Sentence Mode

Toggle with `sentence mode` in the CmdBar. Every `.` isolates the current sentence — one at a time, the rest disappears. Type, hit period, lock and continue.

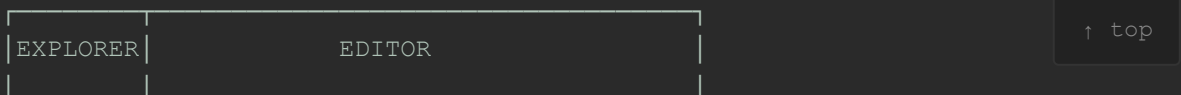
SENTENCE MODE — only one sentence visible at a time:

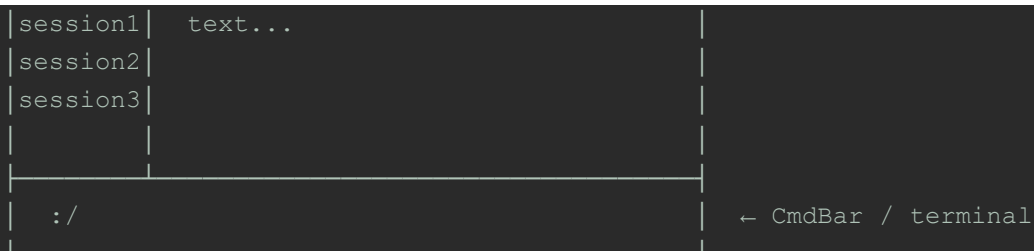


Type → hit `[.]` → sentence locks → next one opens

Layout — three panels

Gombro has three permanent zones:



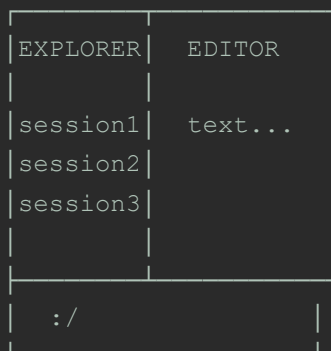


- **Explorer** (left) — session list for the active project.
- **Editor** (center/right) — writing area.
- **CmdBar** (bottom) — command terminal. Open with `:` or `/`. Press `Ctrl+T` for the floating palette.

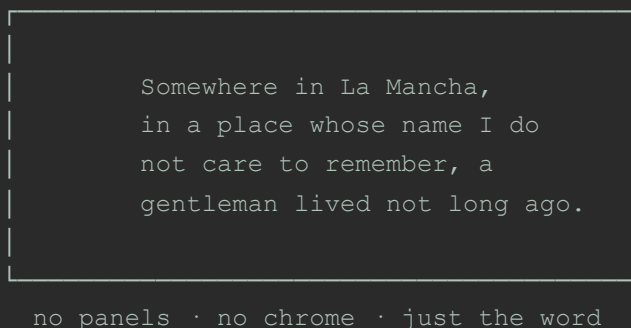
Zen Mode

Expands the editor to full screen. Toggle with `zen` in the CmdBar, or press `Esc` when idle.

NORMAL



ZEN



Keyboard reference

ACTION	HOW
Open CmdBar	<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>
Floating palette	<code>Ctrl+T</code>
Floating search	<code>Ctrl+F</code>

↑ top

New session	<code>Ctrl+N</code>
Open today's diary session	<code>Ctrl+D</code>
Session post-it	<code>F4</code>
Help	<code>F1</code>
Select all text	<code>[Select all]</code> button or right-click
Toggle Sentence Mode	<code>sentence mode</code> in CmdBar
Toggle Zen Mode	<code>zen</code> in CmdBar · <code>Esc</code> from idle
Close CmdBar / search / activate Zen	<code>Esc</code> (cascading)

Chapter 4 — The CmdBar

Press `:` or `/` to open. Press `Esc` to close. Every command works in English and Spanish.

Writing

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>new <name></code> · <code>nuevo <nombre></code>	Create a new session
<code>sentence mode</code> · <code>modo frase</code>	Toggle sentence mode
<code>zen</code>	Toggle zen mode

Projects

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>create project <name></code>	Create a new project

`↑ top`

`open` · `view projects`

Show the project list

Search

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>search <term></code>	Search across all sessions
<code>search <term> in phrases</code>	Search showing individual sentences

Export

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>compile</code> · <code>compilar</code>	Export all sessions to .docx
<code>compile <name></code>	Export with custom filename

Interface

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>help</code> · <code>ayuda</code>	Open the help modal
<code>lang en</code> · <code>lang es</code>	Switch interface language

Chapter 5 — The Explorer

The Explorer is the left panel — your session list, your binder. Every session in the active project lives here.

- `[+]` — create a new session (at the end of the list)
- `[↑]` — import a file (.md, .docx, .txt)

`↑ top`

- The stats at the bottom show totals for the active project

Adding a session or paragraph at position

Right-click a session or a paragraph in the expanded outline to insert new content **directly below** the clicked item:

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Right-click session → Add session below	Creates a new session immediately below that session, ready to rename
Right-click paragraph (outline) → Add paragraph below	Inserts an empty paragraph below — shows "nuevo párrafo" in the explorer until you type

Reordering paragraphs

In the expanded outline you can reorder paragraphs with drag & drop, just like sessions:

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Drag paragraph in outline → drop at new position	Moves the paragraph, saves to DB and reloads the editor

Navigating to a paragraph

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
Click paragraph in outline	Cursor jumps to that paragraph in the editor, ready to type
<code>Enter</code> in the editor	Creates a new paragraph below the cursor (same as "Add paragraph below")

Project stats

STAT	WHAT IT MEASURES	↑ top
------	------------------	-------

Days	How many days you've written in this project
Words	Total word count across all sessions
Sentences	Total sentence count
Commas	Proxy for sentence complexity and rhythm

Multi-select

You can select multiple sessions in the Explorer at once:

GESTURE	WHAT IT DOES
<code>Ctrl+click</code>	Add or remove a session from the selection
<code>Shift+click</code>	Select the range from the last clicked session to this one
<code>Delete</code>	Delete all selected sessions at once

Session context menu

Right-click any session:

Rename

Duplicate

Shuffle (Abarajar)

Undo shuffle

Move up

Move down

Move to <project>

Delete

Move up / Move down — reorder sessions within the project. The order persists. You can also **drag and drop** sessions directly in the list.

↑ top

Chapter 6 — Search and Collections

Search works across the full text of every paragraph in the active project.

```
search gentleman
```

Use phrase mode for sentence-level results:

```
search gentleman in phrases
```

Collections

A Collection is a saved search. After any search, click + **Save as collection**. Name it, save it, and it appears in the Explorer — one click to re-run.

Sessions	[↑]
La Mancha	
The Knight	
Stew and Income	
The Housekeeper	
COLLECTIONS	
▸ The Gentleman arc	
▸ Food & income	
▸ Names debate	

← saved searches, always one click away

Chapter 7 — Paragraph Versions

↑ top

Every time a paragraph changes, Gombro keeps a copy automatically. This is a per-paragraph history — not undo.

Access: right-click a paragraph → *Paragraph versions*, or hover a session in the Explorer → click the clock icon.

VERSION TIMELINE — paragraph 1:

Versions · paragraph 1

[Close]

- CURRENT
Somewhere in La Mancha, in a place whose name I do not care to remember...

— Apr 17 · 11:42am —

Somewhere in La Mancha — a place I'd rather not name — a gentleman lived not so long ago...

[Restore this version]

— Apr 16 · 9:15pm —

In La Mancha, somewhere, a man lived.

[Restore this version]

— Apr 15 · 3:30pm —

There was a man in La Mancha.

[Restore this version]

nothing is deleted — every draft is recoverable

Click **Restore this version** to go back. The current text becomes a new version — nothing is permanently lost.

Chapter 8 — Project Notes

Press `Ctrl+P` to open a scratchpad attached to the active project. Type freely — automatically. Press `Esc` to close.

↑ top

The note does not appear in the Explorer, is not compiled, and has no versions. It's a side table next to your writing desk.

Chapter 9 — Baraja and Cut-up

Baraja takes a paragraph you've written and **mixes it with a random paragraph from elsewhere in the project**. This is the cut-up technique — automated collision, writer decides what stays.

BEFORE BARAJA:

session "Chapter One"

Somewhere in La Mancha,
in a place whose name
I do not care to remember,
a gentleman lived not
long ago...

session "The Knight"

Our gentleman was
approximately fifty years
old; his complexion was
weathered, his flesh
scrawny, his face gaunt.

↓ right-click → Shuffle (Baraja) ↓

AFTER BARAJA — the two collide:

Somewhere in La Mancha, his complexion was weathered,
his flesh scrawny — in a place whose name I do not
care to remember, a gentleman lived not long ago,
one of those who has a lance and ancient shield on
a shelf. A very early riser and a great lover of the hunt.

something new appeared. you didn't plan it.

Right-click any paragraph → **Shuffle (Baraja)**.

If the result doesn't interest you: right-click the session in the Explorer → **Undo shuffle**.

When to use Baraja

- When a paragraph feels stuck

↑ top

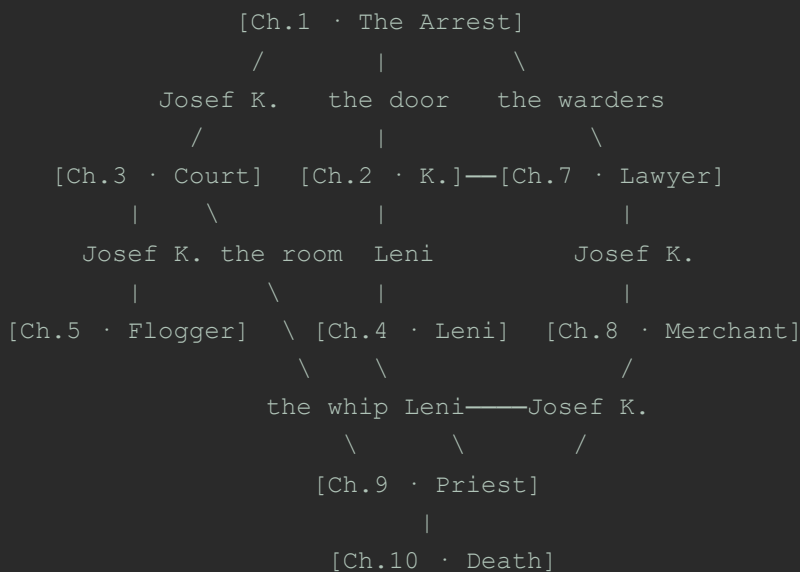
- When you want unexpected connections between sessions
- When the logical next sentence is the last thing you want to write

*Baraja is not a random generator. It is a **prompt from your own writing** — everything it pulls comes from text you already wrote.*

Chapter 10 — Graph View

A visual map of your project. Paragraphs as nodes, connections you draw manually. In the Explorer, click the **Graph** tab.

GRAPH VIEW — The Process · Objects & People:



click any node → opens paragraph in Editor

Ctrl+click multiple → opens all together

- Click + **New graph** to create one (you can have multiple per project)
- Add nodes from your sessions
- Click one node then another to connect them
- Click any node to open that paragraph in the Editor
- Hold **Ctrl** and click multiple nodes to open them together

↑ top

Chapter 11 — Hashtags

Labels you assign manually to individual paragraphs. Track recurring characters, objects, motifs — find all of them instantly.

Right-click a paragraph → # **(hashtags panel)**. Toggle tags on/off, create new ones.

Search by tag the same way as any term:

```
search #housekeeper
```

Chapter 12 — Import and Export

Importing

Click `[↑]` in the Explorer header. Accepts `.txt`, `.md`, `.docx`. Each paragraph/section becomes a session in a new project.

Exporting

```
compile
compile Don Quixote — First Draft
```

All visible sessions, in Explorer order, exported as a single `.docx` file to

`Documents/gombro/{projectName}/`. Project **paths (senderos)** are automatically included at the end, each with its name as a heading.

Chapter 13 — Floor 13

This chapter was intentionally left blank for superstitious reasons. If you are reading this, nothing bad has happened. Yet.

Chapter 13b — Borgian Algebra

Borgian Algebra is Gombro's system for writing with open alternatives — inspired by the way Borges corrected his manuscripts: not erasing, but **branching**.

Inserting a pending fragment

1. Click anywhere to position the cursor (or select a word/phrase)
2. Right-click → **Insert**
3. Type your text in the panel — multiple lines supported
4. Press **ok** (or `Ctrl+Enter`) to insert as a pending Borgian block

If you close the panel without pressing ok, nothing is inserted. The block stays pending until you confirm it.

INSERT FLOW:

cursor here ↓

...a gentleman lived | not long ago...

right-click → Insert

in a place I'd rather forget,	← type here
[ok]	

press ok (or Ctrl+Enter)

result — pending block inserted inline:

...a gentleman lived in a place I'd rather forget, not long ago...

↑ top

```
|| in a place I'd rather ||  
|| forget, ||  
|| _____ ||  
  
(pending — confirm or leave open)
```

Creating a variant from a selection

1. Select any word or phrase
2. Right-click → **Add variant**
3. Type the alternative and press `Enter`

The selected text becomes the first option. Your new text becomes the second. Both appear as a visual block:

SELECT → right-click → Add variant:

...the dog was [dead]

↓

type alternative: "alive"

↓

...the dog was

dead	← original
alive	← new variant

...still barking

add more variants anytime → right-click block → Add variant

Adding sub-variants

You can branch a specific option inside a borgiana block — creating a variant of a variant. This reproduces the tree structure of Borges' manuscripts: each branch can bifurcate into new branches.

1. Right-click on a specific row in the block
2. Choose **Add sub-variant**
3. Type the alternative and press `Ctrl+Enter`

The chosen option becomes a new nested block with two branches — the original and the new one:

↑ top

SUB-VARIANT – branching an existing option:

the dog was walking
the dog was coming

← right-click → Add sub-variant

↓

the dog was walking
the dog was trotting

← nested sub-block

the dog was coming

Internal syntax: {the dog was coming|{the dog was walking|the dog was trotting

There is no depth limit — each branch can keep bifurcating.

Resolving a branch

RESOLVING – Borges style (crossed out, not erased):

right-click "dead" → Choose this:

dead
alive
unconscious

→

dead
~~alive~~
~~unconscious~~

← chosen

← struck (still visible)

right-click → Confirm (collapse) → plain text: "dead"
the alternatives disappear only when YOU decide.

Right-click any row inside the block:

ACTION	EFFECT
Choose this	Strikes through all other options
Strike this	Marks this option as discarded
Confirm (collapse)	Collapses the block to plain text (if one option alive)

↑ top

Struck options remain **visible** — like Borges' crossed-out words. They don't disappear until you confirm.

Syntax

Internally stored as `{option1|option2|~~struck~~}`. You never see this while writing — the editor renders the visual block automatically.

The philosophy

*Borgian Algebra is a way of **holding contradictions open** — of writing a text that contains its own alternatives without forcing a resolution.*

Borges wrote: "Time forks perpetually toward innumerable futures." Borgian Algebra is the word processor that believes him.

Chapter 13c — The Diary

The Diary is a special project that Gombro maintains separately from your writing projects. One session per day, named automatically with the date. Press `Ctrl+D` from anywhere to open it.

EXPLORER — diary always last:

▸ PROJECT: Don Quixote	
La Mancha	
The Knight	
▸ PROJECT: DIARIO	← always at the bottom
Wed, 22 April, 26	← today (auto-created)
Tue, 21 April, 26	
Mon, 20 April, 26	

↑ top

How it works

- `Ctrl+D` from anywhere — opens today's session, creating it if it doesn't exist
- Session names are literary dates: *Wed, 22 April, 26*
- `Ctrl+N` is disabled in diary mode — one session per day, created automatically
- At midnight, Gombro auto-switches to the next day's session
- Available via slash menu: type `/` → *diary* or *diario*

FLOW:

Press `Ctrl+D` anywhere

↓

Is today's session open?

YES NO

↓

stay
there

↓

auto-create
"Wed, 22 Apr, 26"

↓

open in editor

↓

write freely — saved automatically

↓

midnight → tomorrow's session opens

The diary is not a project — it is a habit. Gombro keeps it out of the way of your fiction, always at the bottom of the list, always one keystroke away.

Chapter 13d — Schrödinger Mode

In 1935 Erwin Schrödinger described a cat locked in a box: without opening the box, the cat is simultaneously alive *and* dead. Only when observed does it collapse into one of the two states.

Gombro's Schrödinger Mode applies that logic to text: some fragments are not yet a thing or the other. They exist on the page — but they haven't been decided.

↑ top

What is quantum text?

A paragraph is in Schrödinger state when it contains any of these:

TYPE	HOW IT LOOKS	WHAT IT MEANS
Strikethrough	struck-through text	Marked for possible deletion — not decided yet
Borgian variant	<code>{option A option B}</code>	Text in superposition — two possible futures, uncollapsed

The strikethrough says: *"this might be too much."*

The variant says: *"this could be this, or that."*

Neither is final. The text remains open.

How to strikethrough text

Select any fragment → right-click → **Strikethrough**. The text stays visible but crossed out.

```
| ...in a place in La Mancha, whose name  
| ~~I do not care to remember~~, not long ago...  
|
```

↑ the editor shows visual strikethrough;
the ~~ markers are hidden but saved

Then right-click on the struck-through text:

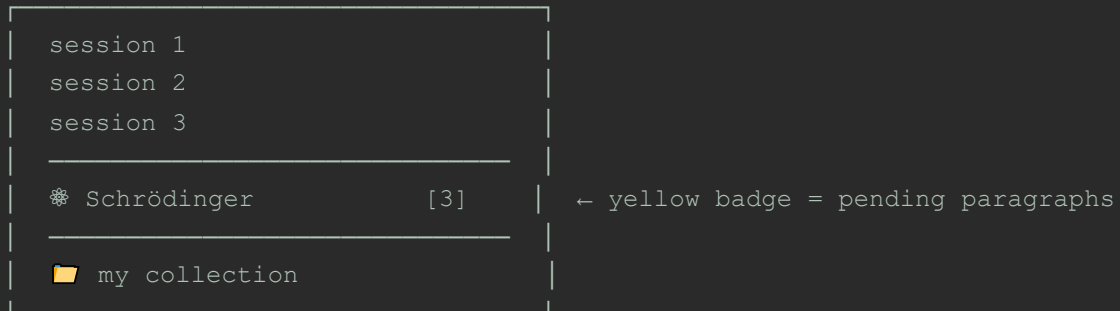
```
| Delete ← removes the fragment entirely  
| Edit ← removes strikethrough, text becomes editable  
|
```

Edit is the Borgian option: you don't erase the thought, you transform it. Write the replacement, press Enter — the text stays clean with no strikethrough.

The ☸ Schrödinger button

↑ top

At the bottom of the Explorer, above the Collections, the Schrödinger button is always visible:



- The **badge** updates automatically when you switch projects or save
- **Click** to see the list of paragraphs in quantum state
- Click any result to jump directly to it in the editor

The Schrödinger list

Clicking ☼ shows pending paragraphs grouped by session — same UI as search results:

The screenshot shows a window titled '☼ Schrödinger [3] [X close]'. It contains three sections separated by horizontal lines: 'Chapter One' with the text '~~I do not care to remember~~, not long...', 'Chapter Two' with the text '...there lived a hidalgo {of the lance|with a lance} in the rack...', and 'Epilogue' with the text '~~This part is redundant~~ · The story...'.

Schrödinger and compile

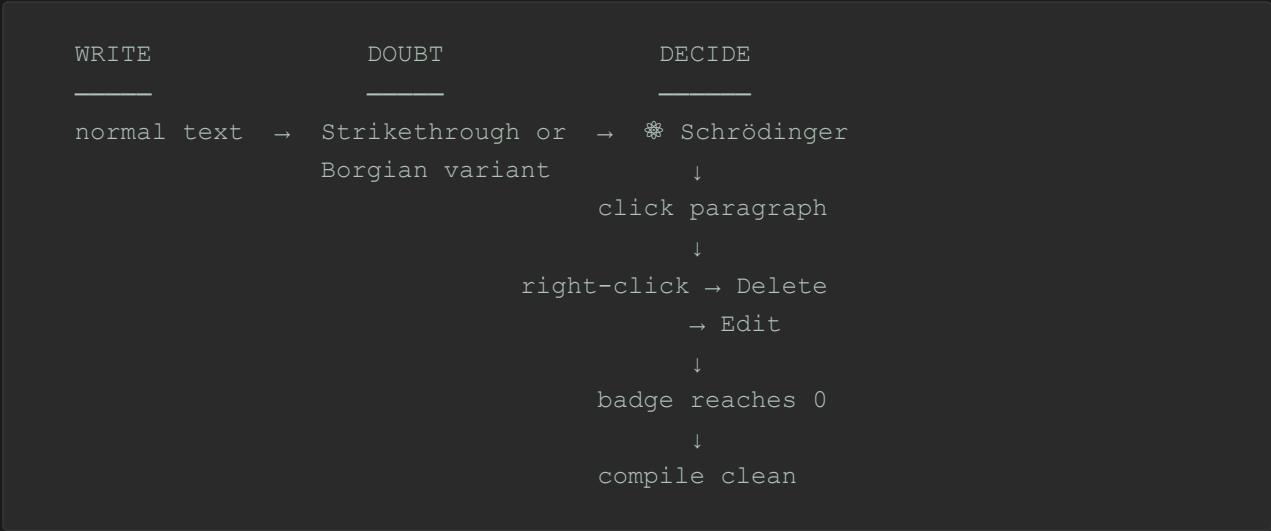
When you compile to `docx` or `md`, Gombro scans the project. If there are Schrödinger paragraphs, a notice appears before generating the file:

The screenshot shows a notice box with the text: '☼ 3 paragraphs in Schrödinger state (strikethroughs or unresolved variants)'.

↑ top

You can still compile — it is just a reminder. Struck-through text will appear struck through in the docx; uncollapsed Borgian variants will appear in their raw form.

The full workflow



Borges crossed out but never erased. He kept the discarded text visible — proof that the thought had been there. Schrödinger Mode is exactly that: a space for doubt before decision.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Strikethrough selection	Select → right-click → Strikethrough
Delete strikethrough	Right-click struck text → Delete
Edit strikethrough	Right-click struck text → Edit → type → Enter
View pending paragraphs	Click ⌘ Schrödinger in the Explorer
Keyboard shortcut	Ctrl+Q
Command	schrodinger in the CmdBar

Chapter 13e — Writing Plan

The Writing Plan is a dashboard that shows how much you've written — today, this week, and over the past months. It's not a productivity tool. It's a mirror.

How to open it

Type `/` in the CmdBar and select **Writing plan** (or **Plan de escritura** in Spanish). The panel appears on the right side of the Explorer.

What it shows

- **Today** — words written today, with an optional daily goal. Click `set` to define your goal.
- **This week** — a bar chart of the last 7 days.
- **Weeks** — weekly totals for the past months.
- **Months** — monthly totals.

The daily goal

You can set a daily word goal. Gombro counts every word you write in the active project. When you reach the goal, the bar fills up. There is no alarm, no notification — just a quiet record.

A writing plan is not a deadline. It is a habit made visible.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Open Writing Plan	<code>/plan</code> in the CmdBar
Set daily goal	Click <code>set</code> next to the Goal field
Close panel	Click <code>×</code> in the panel header <code>↑ top</code>

Chapter 13f — Session Notes and Badges

Every session in the Explorer can have its own note — a free-form annotation visible at a glance. A small badge () appears on sessions that have notes, so you can tell at a glance which sessions have context attached.

How to add a note to a session

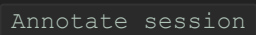
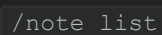
1. Right-click the session name in the Explorer.
2. Select **Annotate session**.
3. A small panel opens. Type your note.
4. The note saves automatically.

Notes can also be anchored to specific paragraphs using  while writing.

The badge

Sessions with at least one note show a  badge in the Explorer. This lets you mark sessions that need attention, have context, or are works in progress — without opening them.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Add note to session	Right-click session → 
Add note to paragraph	 while cursor is in the paragraph
View all notes	 in the CmdBar

Chapter 13g — Hashtag Filtering in the Explorer

If your project uses hashtags, you can filter the session list by hashtag directly from the Explorer — no need to open the search panel.

How it works

At the bottom of the Explorer, your project hashtags appear as small tags. Click one to show only sessions that contain that hashtag. Click again to remove the filter.

This is useful when a project has many sessions and you want to focus on sessions related to a specific theme, character, or location.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Filter by hashtag	Click the hashtag tag in the Explorer
Remove filter	Click the active hashtag again
Manage hashtags	<code>/tag</code> in the CmdBar

Chapter 13h — Text Scale

You can adjust the size of the text in the editor without changing the font or the style. This is purely for reading comfort — like the zoom level in a word processor.

How to change the scale

Type `/scale` (or `/escala` in Spanish) in the CmdBar. Enter a number between 50 and 300. The number represents a percentage: `100` is the default size, `125` makes `↑ top` larger, `80` makes it smaller.

```
/scale 125    → larger text (25% above default)
/scale 80     → smaller text (20% below default)
/scale 100    → back to default
```

The setting is saved automatically and persists when you reopen Gombro.

This does not change the font, the line height, or the style of headings. It only scales the base size — like moving closer or farther from the page.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Change text scale	<code>/scale [50-300]</code> in the CmdBar
Reset to default	<code>/scale 100</code>

Chapter 13i — Obsidian Notebook

Obsidian is a note-taking application for writers and thinkers. It stores notes as plain text files (`.md`) on your computer — no cloud, no subscription required. You can download it for free at obsidian.md.

If you use Obsidian alongside Gombro, the **Obsidian Notebook** lets you bring your Obsidian notes into your writing project automatically.

How the connection works

Obsidian and Gombro both run on your computer. Gombro finds your Obsidian vault automatically — you don't need to configure any paths or settings.

The connection is based on **hashtags**. If your Gombro project is called *Kolon*, Gombro will look for Obsidian notes that contain `#kolon`. Each matching note appears in the Obsidian Notebook panel.

↑ top

Typical workflow

1. You're out, reading, thinking. You open Obsidian on your phone or laptop and write a note: *"The colonel's uniform touches the ground when he walks. #kolon"*
2. Back at your desk, you open Gombro and open the Kolon project.
3. A notification appears: **"You have new notes in Obsidian."**
4. You type `/obsidian` in the CmdBar. The Obsidian Notebook opens.
5. You see the note. You copy it into your session. Done.

The Obsidian Notebook panel

- Shows only **new or modified** notes since the last time you checked.
- Each note has two buttons:  **Copy** (copies content to clipboard, removes from view) and  **Dismiss** (marks as read — won't appear again unless the note changes in Obsidian).
- Click **Actualizar / Refresh** to re-scan the vault.

Multiple projects

The hashtag is derived from the project name automatically. Project *Quixote* → looks for `#quixote`. You can use multiple hashtags in a single Obsidian note to send it to multiple projects.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Open Obsidian Notebook	<code>/obsidian</code> in the CmdBar
Copy a note	Click  — copies to clipboard, removes from view
Dismiss a note	Click  — marks as read, won't reappear
Refresh	Click Actualizar in the panel
Download Obsidian	obsidian.md (free)

↑ top

Chapter 13j — Backup and Recovery

Gombro stores everything in a single SQLite file: `gombro.db`. Backup means copying that file. Recovery means replacing it with an older copy.

How it works

Automatic backup — every time you close Gombro, a backup is saved automatically. No configuration needed.

Manual backup — type `backup` in the CmdBar at any time to save a snapshot immediately.

Recovery — type `recover` in the CmdBar to open the backup list. Select any entry and click **Restore selected**.

Where backups are stored

By default, backups go to a folder called `backup_gombro` next to the database file:

```
%AppData%\gombro\backup_gombro\  
gombro-2026-04-29_10-00-00.db  
gombro-2026-04-30_09-15-00.db
```

Changing the backup folder

Open the recovery modal (`recover`) and click **Change...** — a native folder dialog opens. Choose any folder: Dropbox, Google Drive, an external drive. The setting is saved and applies to all subsequent backups, including auto-backups on close. You can change it at any time.

Backup rotation

Gombro keeps the **10 most recent backups**. When a new one is created and the count exceeds 10, the oldest is deleted automatically.

↑ top

Restoring a backup

1. Type `recover` in the CmdBar.
2. Select a backup from the list.
3. Click **Restore selected**.

Gombro closes the database, replaces it with the chosen backup, and reloads all data immediately. No restart needed.

Reference

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>backup</code>	Save a snapshot now
<code>recover</code>	Open backup list and restore

Chapter 13k — Paths (Narrative Labyrinths)

A **Path** (Sendero) is a fork. From any paragraph you can open an alternative route — a version of the story that splits at that exact point and continues on its own. Think of it as a garden of forking paths: the text branches, it does not replace.

Creating a path

Right-click on the paragraph where you want to fork and choose 🌿 **Senderear desde aquí**. Gombro creates the path and registers it in the Explorer panel under the **SENDEROS** section.

The path name is generated automatically: `Ses: [session name] — párrafo: [first words]`. You can rename it by right-clicking in the Explorer.

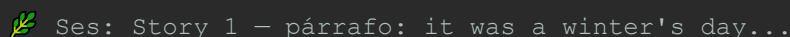
Opening a path

↑ top

Click on the path in the Explorer. It opens as its own session — with the inherited content up to the fork point — ready for you to write forward. What you write in the path does not touch the original session.

The origin banner

When a path is open, a green bar appears at the top of the editor:



That text is **clickable**: clicking it takes you back to the origin session at the fork point.

Paths and compile

When you compile the project (`compile` or `compile .md`), paths are automatically included at the end of the document, each with its name as a heading. No extra steps needed.

Reference

ACTION	HOW
Create a path	Right-click on paragraph →  Senderear desde aquí
Open a path	Click the path in the Explorer
Return to origin	Click the green banner at the top of the editor
Rename	Right-click the path → Rename
Delete	Right-click the path → Delete path

From blank project to exported draft — a suggestion, not a rule.

Phase 1 — Open the instrument

```
create project Don Quixote  
new La Mancha
```

Write until the session is done, then create another. Don't organize yet.

Phase 2 — Let chance work

Pick a paragraph that feels stuck. Right-click → Baraja. Keep what surprised you. Undo what didn't work. Use **Sentence Mode** when you want to slow down.

Phase 3 — Tag and map

Tag recurring elements. Open the Graph, build a visual map of connections.

Phase 4 — Search and collect

Search for elements to track. Save useful searches as Collections. Use Paragraph Versions to compare and restore.

Phase 5 — Export

Arrange sessions in the Explorer in the order you want. Then:

```
compile Don Quixote — First Draft
```

Open the `.docx` for final formatting and submission.

```

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   - - -
  ' - . - '
 / |      | \
 / | RAÚL  | \
 / | LILLOY | \
 / | '-----' \
 |  ☕  📄  |
 |  Gombro  |
 |  v0.0.5β  |
 | '~~~~~' |

```

"Writing is... I don't know.
That's why I write."

Alphabetical Index

CONCEPT / ACTION	HOW	CHAPTER
Backup / Recovery	<code>backup</code> · <code>recover</code>	13j
Baraja (cut-up)	Right-click paragraph → Baraja	9
Borgian Algebra	Select text → right-click → Add variant · <code>/paths</code>	13b
Borgian insert	Right-click → Insert	13b
CmdBar	<code>:</code> or <code>/</code>	4
Collections	Search → + Save as collection	6
Compile / Export	<code>compile [name]</code>	12
Create project	<code>create project <name></code>	2
Diary	<code>diary</code> · <code>Ctrl+D</code>	13c
Graph	Explorer → Graph tab → New graph	10
Graph — multi-select nodes	<code>Ctrl+click</code> nodes	10
Graph — search nodes	Graph search bar	↑ top

CONCEPT / ACTION	HOW	CHAPTER
Hashtags	Right-click paragraph → # (hashtags panel)	11
Hashtag filter in Explorer	Click hashtag tag in Explorer sidebar	13g
Help	<code>help</code> · <code>F1</code>	—
Import file	↑ (Explorer header) — .md / .docx / .txt	12
Notes (project)	<code>F4</code> · right-click session → Annotate session	8
Notes — session badges	Right-click session → Annotate session	13f
Obsidian Notebook	<code>obsidian</code>	13i
Writing Plan	<code>plan</code>	13e
Paragraph versions	Right-click paragraph → Versions	7
Projects — list	<code>open</code> · <code>view projects</code>	5
Reveal in Explorer	Right-click paragraph → Reveal in Binder	5
Reveal source (after Baraja)	Explorer → ⌘ reveal source	9
Scale (text size)	<code>scale [50-300]</code>	13h
Schrödinger mode	<code>schrodinger</code> · <code>Ctrl+Q</code>	13d
Search	<code>search <term></code> · <code>Ctrl+F</code>	6
Search in phrases	<code>search <term> in phrases</code>	6
Sentence mode	<code>sentence mode</code>	3
Sessions — new	<code>new [name]</code> · <code>Ctrl+N</code>	5
Sessions — reorder	Right-click → Move up / Move down · Drag & drop	5
Sessions — multi-select	<code>Ctrl+click</code> sessions	5
Shuffle sentences	<code>shuffle</code>	9
Undo shuffle	Right-click session → Undo shuffle	9
Zen mode	<code>zen</code>	↑ top

